

Soft Skills and Interpersonal Communication

Easy Answers (3 Marks Each)

1. Recall the characteristics of effective communication?

1. **Clear** - the message is simple and easy to understand.
2. **Concise** - short and to the point, no extra words.
3. **Correct** - facts, grammar and figures are right.
4. **Complete** - has all the information the receiver needs.
5. **Courteous** - polite, respectful and friendly tone.

Funny Example: Mom says, "Bring some vegetables." You bring only 1 kg of green chillies. Message was not clear or complete - now dinner is VERY spicy!

2. Define soft skill and its components?

1. **Definition:** Soft skills are personal and people skills that help us work well with others.
2. **Communication** - speaking, listening and writing clearly.
3. **Teamwork and Leadership** - working together and guiding others.
4. **Emotional intelligence** - handling our own and others' feelings.
5. **Problem solving and time management** - thinking smartly and finishing work on time.

Funny Example: Hard skill: you can cook biryani. Soft skill: you can politely tell your friends the biryani is finished, without starting a war.

3. Importance of active listening in communication?

- 1. Avoids misunderstanding** - you get the message right.
- 2. Builds trust** - the speaker feels respected.
- 3. Better relationships** - everyone likes a good listener.
- 4. Improves problem solving** - you know the full problem.
- 5. Saves time and mistakes** - no need to repeat again and again.

Funny Example: Mom says, "Take the blue bag, not the red one." You said "hmm hmm" while watching reels and took the red bag. Result: a free lecture!

4. Write a short note on interpersonal & intrapersonal communication?

- 1. Intrapersonal** - communication with yourself (thinking, self-talk).
- 2. Interpersonal** - communication between two or more people.
- 3. Intrapersonal examples:** planning your day, self-motivation, praying.
- 4. Interpersonal examples:** chatting, meetings, phone calls, interviews.
- 5. Both are important** - one builds confidence, the other builds relationships.

Funny Example: You tell yourself in the mirror, "Today I will study!" (intrapersonal). You tell your friend the same, and he laughs (interpersonal).

5. Write a business letter inquiring about a job vacancy in a reputed company?

Format: sender's address and date, receiver's address, subject, body, closing.

Rahul Sharma
12 Gandhi Road, Pune - 411001
19 September 2026

The HR Manager
ABC Technologies Ltd.
MG Road, Pune - 411002

Subject: Inquiry about job vacancy

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to ask whether your reputed company has any vacancy for the post of Marketing Executive. I have completed my B.Com and I have good communication and teamwork skills. My resume is attached for your kind consideration. I will be grateful if you inform me about any suitable opening and the selection process. Thank you for your time.

Yours faithfully,
Rahul Sharma

Funny Example: Do not write "Bro, any job? I am free." Keep it polite and formal!

6. Define the role of negotiation and persuasion and its application in the workplace?

1. **Negotiation** - discussion to reach an agreement acceptable to both sides.
2. **Persuasion** - convincing others to accept your idea or take action.
3. **Role:** solves disagreements and creates win-win deals.
4. **Application:** salary talks, client deals, supplier prices.
5. **Also used for:** getting team support for ideas and fixing deadlines.

Funny Example: You ask mom for 1 more hour of mobile. She offers 10 minutes. After some smart talking you settle at 30 minutes. Congrats, you are a negotiator!

7. Explain the importance of leadership skills in the cooperative environment?

1. **Gives direction** - team knows the goal and the path.
2. **Motivates members** - keeps energy and morale high.
3. **Encourages cooperation** - all work together, not alone.
4. **Solves conflicts** - keeps peace in the team.
5. **Better results** - work is done faster and with quality.

Funny Example: A team without a leader is like friends deciding where to eat: 2 hours, no decision. A leader says, "Biryani!" Problem solved.

8. Explain what do you understand by SMART goals?

1. **S - Specific:** clear and exact ("Score 80% in exam").
2. **M - Measurable:** progress can be tracked with numbers.
3. **A - Achievable:** realistic and possible.
4. **R - Relevant:** matters to your life or career.
5. **T - Time-bound:** has a fixed deadline.

Funny Example: "I will get fit" is not SMART. "I will walk 30 minutes daily for 1 month" is SMART. "I will lose 10 kg by tomorrow" is not Achievable!

9. Why does conflict usually arise during the storming stage of team development?

1. **Real personalities appear** - members stop being polite and show true opinions.
2. **Different ideas** - working styles and thoughts clash.
3. **Power struggle** - everyone wants to lead or be heard.
4. **Unclear roles** - confusion about who does what.
5. **Work pressure** - stress about goals increases arguments.

Funny Example: It is like the first week in a hostel: everyone is polite. In week two, someone uses your shampoo. That is storming!

10. Identify the common mistakes to be avoided while setting goals?

1. **Vague goals** - like "I want to be successful".
2. **Too many goals** - nothing gets completed.
3. **Unrealistic goals** - impossible targets cause disappointment.
4. **No deadline or action plan** - goal stays only a dream.
5. **No review** - not checking progress or giving up after one failure.

Funny Example: New Year resolution: "Wake up at 5 AM daily." On 2 January, the alarm was snoozed 5 times.

11. Discuss how emotional intelligence can be used to build and maintain relationships at the workplace?

1. **Self-awareness** - knowing your feelings so you do not shout at colleagues.
2. **Empathy** - understanding others' feelings and views.
3. **Self-control** - staying calm during stress and criticism.
4. **Good listening** - solving issues politely.
5. **Kind feedback** - handling conflicts gently builds trust.

Funny Example: Boss is angry. An EI person says, "Sir, you look tense. Shall I bring chai?" Boss is calm. Relationship saved!

12. Explain the main objectives of team formation?

- 1. Achieve common goals** - finish work together.
- 2. Share workload** - big tasks become easy.
- 3. Use different skills** - every member has a special talent.
- 4. Better ideas and decisions** - many minds, many ideas.
- 5. Motivation and support** - members help each other.

Funny Example: In a bad group project, 1 topper works and 4 friends add their names. A real team means everyone works!

13. How does critical thinking help in problem solving?

- 1. Finds the real problem** - not just the symptoms.
- 2. Checks facts** - avoids false information.
- 3. Finds many solutions** - compares the options.
- 4. Avoids bias** - decisions are logical, not emotional.
- 5. Chooses the best solution** and checks the result.

Funny Example: Phone is not charging. No thinking: "Phone is dead, buy a new one!" Critical thinking: check the switch. It was OFF.

14. How does effective communication help in clearing an interview?

- 1. Clear introduction** - makes a good first impression.
- 2. Correct and confident answers** - shows your knowledge.
- 3. Good body language** - eye contact, smile, straight posture.
- 4. Active listening** - understand the question before answering.
- 5. Shows personality** - interviewer trusts your attitude.

Funny Example: Interviewer: "Tell me about yourself." Candidate: "Sir, I like biryani and sleeping." Talk about skills, not snacks!

15. Explain how teamwork & collaboration can help in achieving organizational goals?

- 1. Faster work** - tasks are divided and shared.
- 2. Better quality** - different skills come together.
- 3. Better problem solving** - ideas are shared.
- 4. Higher morale** - less stress, happy employees.
- 5. Same direction** - everyone works for the company goal.

Funny Example: One ant cannot carry a biscuit. Many ants together? The biscuit reaches home. That is teamwork!

16. Distinguish between hearing and listening?

Point	Hearing	Listening
Meaning	Natural process of sound entering ears	Conscious process of understanding sound
Effort	No effort needed	Effort and attention needed
Nature	Automatic	Intentional
Understanding	May not understand	Understands and remembers
Skill	A physical ability	A skill that can be learned

Funny Example: Hearing: you hear mom shout, "Wake up!"
Listening: you actually wake up.

17. What is paraphrasing in active listening? How does it improve communication?

1. **Meaning:** repeating the speaker's message in your own words.
2. **Example:** "So you are saying the report is late because data came late?"
3. **Confirms understanding** - you got it right.
4. **Removes confusion** - misunderstandings are cleared quickly.
5. **Shows respect** - the speaker feels heard and trusts you.

Funny Example: Friend: "I am so hungry." You: "So you want me to buy you a samosa?" Friend: "Exactly!" Paraphrasing works.

18. Mention any two characteristics of an effective speaker?

Exam tip: first 2 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Clear voice and pronunciation** - the audience understands easily.
2. **Confidence** - speaks without fear and with eye contact.
3. **Good knowledge** of the topic.
4. **Good body language** - gestures and posture.
5. **Audience awareness** - short, simple and interesting talk.

Funny Example: A speaker who reads every slide word by word is not effective. The audience reads faster and falls asleep!

19. Define Emotional Intelligence and mention one way in which it contributes to professional success?

Exam tip: first 2 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Definition:** ability to understand and control your own emotions and understand others' emotions.
2. **Contribution:** it helps you stay calm under pressure and take better decisions.
3. **Better teamwork** through empathy.
4. **Better customer handling** and leadership.
5. **Accepts criticism** in a positive way.

Funny Example: Customer shouts. Low EI: you shout back and get fired. High EI: "Sir, I understand." You get promoted!

20. Define persuasion and mention any two characteristics of effective persuasion?

Exam tip: first 3 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Definition:** convincing others to accept your idea or take action, without force.
2. **Credibility** - the audience trusts the speaker.
3. **Logic and facts** - reasons and proof support the idea.
4. **Emotional appeal** - connects with the audience's feelings.
5. **Audience focus** - polite and win-win approach.

Funny Example: Kid to dad: "Papa, this phone helps my studies, and all my friends have it!" (Logic + emotion. Dad is 50% convinced.)

21. What is teamwork? Mention any two characteristics of an effective team?

Exam tip: first 3 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Teamwork:** a group of people working together for a common goal.
2. **Clear common goal** - everyone knows the target.
3. **Good communication and trust** among members.
4. **Defined roles** - each one knows their job.
5. **Mutual respect and support.**

Funny Example: In a boat, if one person rows left and the other rows right, the boat goes round and round. Same direction is teamwork!

22. Define active listening and mention two characteristics of an effective active listener?

Exam tip: first 3 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Definition:** fully concentrating on, understanding and responding to the speaker.
2. **Full attention** - no phone, no distractions.
3. **Shows interest** - eye contact, nodding, asking questions.
4. **Patient** - does not interrupt the speaker.
5. **Non-judgmental** - listens with an open mind.

Funny Example: A bad listener says, "Yes, yes, I am listening" while scrolling reels. A good listener puts the phone down.

23. What is effective speaking? Mention two objectives of effective speaking?

Exam tip: first 3 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Meaning:** delivering your message clearly and confidently so the audience understands and responds.
2. **Objective 1: To inform** - give clear information.
3. **Objective 2: To persuade** - convince the audience.
4. **To motivate or entertain** the listeners.
5. **To build a good impression** and relationships.

Funny Example: A best friend's wedding speech informs, persuades, entertains and makes everyone cry, all in 2 minutes!

24. What is proxemics? Name any two types of interpersonal distance?

Exam tip: first 3 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Proxemics:** study of how people use space and distance while communicating (by Edward Hall).
2. **Intimate distance:** 0 to 18 inches - hugging, close family.
3. **Personal distance:** 1.5 to 4 feet - friends and family.
4. **Social distance:** 4 to 12 feet - colleagues, formal talks.
5. **Public distance:** more than 12 feet - speeches, lectures.

Funny Example: A stranger sits right next to you in an empty bus. He has entered your intimate zone. You move seats quickly!

26. Explain self-regulation as a component of Emotional Intelligence?

1. **Meaning:** ability to control your emotions, impulses and reactions.
2. **Stays calm** in stress and pressure.
3. **Thinks before acting** - no angry decisions.
4. **Adapts to change** easily.
5. **Takes responsibility** - honest and trustworthy.

Funny Example: Boss scolds you and you want to send "I QUIT!" by email. Self-regulation says: save as draft, drink water.

27. Differentiate between distributive and integrative negotiation?

Point	Distributive	Integrative
Meaning	Fixed pie: one wins, one loses	Both sides gain
Approach	Win-Lose	Win-Win
Focus	Positions	Interests and needs
Relationship	Short-term, may be harmed	Long-term, strengthened
Example	Bargaining the price of a car	Employer and employee agree on flexible timing and fair pay

Funny Example: Two sisters fight for 1 orange. Distributive: cut it in half. Integrative: one wants juice, the other wants the peel for cake. Both get 100%!

28. Define leadership and mention any two characteristics of an effective leader?

Exam tip: first 3 points are enough for 3 marks. The rest are bonus.

1. **Definition:** ability to guide, influence and motivate people to achieve a goal.
2. **Vision** - clear direction for the team.
3. **Integrity** - honest and fair.
4. **Good communication** skills.
5. **Decision making** and empathy.

Funny Example: A boss says, "Go!" A leader says, "Let's go!" (and also brings the map).
